

Aaron Amerling

Strategic Marketing & Product Leader. Brand, Growth & Innovation. San Diego, CA

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Executive Summary

Strategic marketing and product leader with 20+ years of experience defining direction and driving growth at key inflection points—from early-stage startups to enterprise organizations. Known for identifying high-leverage opportunities across product, brand, and go-to-market, and building the strategy and systems to execute.

Background spans agency leadership, in-house product and marketing roles, and early-stage advisory work. Combines performance marketing, product development, and narrative-driven positioning to unlock growth.

Strategic Advisory & Innovation

GoFundMe | Early Marketing Advisor (2008–2012)

- Worked with founders during early concept development (pre-GoFundMe, “Create-A-Fund”), contributing to positioning as the platform evolved into a social crowdfunding model
- Served as first marketing advisor, helping shape early strategy, train the initial marketing hire, and manage the company’s first marketing agency

TrendSource | Strategic Marketing Advisor

- Repositioned market research firm and rebuilt go-to-market strategy, increasing inbound MQLs from ~5/year to 100+/month
- Developed content and SEO strategy leveraging proprietary research, driving enterprise demand from Fortune 10 companies (Apple, Google)
- Achieved top search rankings for competitive market research terms, outperforming incumbents including Nielsen

Steno.ai | Strategic Advisor

- Identified high-value use case for AI “digital twin” technology in influencer and expert markets
- Initiated and led engagement with Tony Robbins, guiding positioning and deal execution to secure him as the company’s inaugural flagship customer and brand advocate

Narrative Development (Supporting)

- Nickelodeon Writing Fellow – Avatar: The Last Airbender (writers' room, uncredited)
- Script Consultant (uncredited) – All Quiet on the Western Front

Professional Experience

Etna Interactive | Chief Marketing Officer (2024–2026)

- Led strategic direction across the agency's client portfolio, setting positioning and growth frameworks used across engagements
- Oversaw strategy, paid media, owned/earned media, and client services functions
- Guided internal teams on positioning, go-to-market, and growth strategy
- Restructured organization to support SME-driven model
- Repositioned pricing and service model to improve margins

The Lemonade Agency | VP Strategy (Head of Strategy) (2022–2024)

- Owned agency-wide strategy across global client portfolio
- Led strategic direction for Disney, Meta, Square Enix, Ubisoft, DirecTV
- Worked with executive stakeholders to define positioning and growth strategy
- Reversed decline for San Francisco Marathon via repositioning
- Guided cross-functional campaign execution

TEAM LEWIS | Managing Director, US Digital (2021–2022)

- Led digital strategy across enterprise clients including VMware and Ripple
- Managed multi-million dollar engagements and scopes

Voxox / Telcentris | Director, Marketing & Product Innovation (2017–2021)

- Led product strategy and GTM, driving 50% conversion growth and 80% ARPU increase
- Created VoxDirect B2B SaaS product
- Defined product direction based on market trends

GAIN Credit | Senior Manager (2016–2017)

- Managed \$40M+ digital budget
- Led Drafty product marketing (Fintech Product of the Year)
- Scaled paid channels to top revenue driver

Best Buy Health (GreatCall) | Senior Manager (2012–2016)

- Launched Urgent Care telehealth product
- App Store Editor's Choice, #1 Medical app, CONNECT award runner-up
- Grew app users from 25K to 1.5M+
- Drove 400% e-comm growth, reduced CPA ~60%
- Built innovation lab contributing to patents

Selected Consulting Experience

- Advised organizations including American Medical Response on SEO and digital strategy
- Developed brand positioning, content strategy, and in-product messaging for entertainment and media brands including DirecTV, MTV, Spike, and Current TV
- Provided go-to-market strategy and messaging across industries

Patents & Recognition

- Co-inventor on 5 U.S. patents in mobile health and wireless technology
- Recipient of Telly and Communicator Awards

Education

University of California, Santa Cruz – B.A. History

San Diego State University – M.A. Digital Media, TV & Film